policies, which resulted in religious intolerance and extremism. They did not take these steps out of sincerity to Islam but due to political exigencies, which could help them prolong their respective regimes.

Kashmir became the first and foremost bone of contention between Pakistan and India. The first jihad was directed towards the liberation of Kashmir from India in 1948.

Chapter 2 describes the history of religious extremism and terrorism in the following four phases in order to understand the origin of terrorism from religious extremism and flawed policies: (1) Afghan jihad formed jihadi parties and jihadi culture from 1979 onwards; (2) Indian-sponsored terrorism and sabotage in the 1980s; (3) sectarian terrorism erupted in the late 1980s and (4) the rise of militancy after 2001, involving Al Qaeda, TTP and so on. This chapter deals with the first phase. The main parties involved in sectarianism and jihad have been discussed in detail. These parties were created to fight in Afghanistan against the Soviets and to support freedom fighters in Indian-held Kashmir (IHK). Pakistani religious groups sent thousands of jihadists to fight in Afghan jihad. Pakistanis were made to believe that it was their religious and moral duty to be sympathetic towards these jihadists.

After the withdrawal of the Soviet forces from Afghanistan in 1988, within four years, Pakistan started losing interest in affairs related to Afghanistan (Khan, 2011). It then increased its focus on Kashmir, and by the mid-1990s, the indigenous uprising, abetted by the militants and the jihadi parties from Pakistan, became quite violent. However, this focus was expected to end soon.

After the 9/11 terrorist attack, Pakistan made a U-turn on Afghan and Kashmir policies. The IHK-centric Jihadi organisations were banned in the Musharraf regime. The Pakistanis who fought or supported those wars and conflicts with the approval of their own government were left in the lurch without any further guidance. Post-operation care was non-existent. Psychological and physical rehabilitation of trained and battle-hardened fighters, to reintroduce them in the society, was not considered necessary. It not only confused and agitated their ideological frame of mind, but also rendered them jobless. However, the regrouping of Al Qaeda, the resurgence of Afghan Taliban and the birth of local Taliban attracted a number of these elements from Pakistani religious jihadi organisations. Their training, temperament and experience made them very useful for Al Qaeda and TTP.